

SAMĀDHI WATER REPENTANCE

SCROLL ONE PRACTICE GUIDE

An explained English guide to the opening scroll

origin • refuge • afflictions • vows • wisdom

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EXPANDED COMPANION EDITION

Scroll One Practice Companion

Origins, refuge, afflictions, vows and wisdom

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Source edition

Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple, Electronic Edition 3.0, April 2022.
English translation, editing and design by Andrew Nguy and Raymond Kong.

This independent companion explains the source liturgy. It is not a replacement translation or an official temple edition. Source-page references count PDF pages; printed page numbers are given where useful. In communal practice, follow the officiant's instructions.

The original liturgies remain copyrighted by Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple and are linked in the references. New explanations and reading notes are clearly distinguished from source wording.

Further Buddhist terminology: www.fgsitc.org/glossary/

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Scroll One

What each part is doing and why

An explained companion to Scroll One

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For other Buddhist terms, visit the Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center Glossary.

This companion explains the English text of the 2022 Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple edition. It does not reproduce or replace the liturgy. Keep the official Scroll One PDF beside this guide when reading or chanting.

How to use this guide

Read “The Buddhist world behind the words” first if the terms karma, Pure Land, emptiness or bodhisattva are new. Then use the page-by-page guide below while following the source.

Source-page references use the PDF page number. The smaller printed number inside the liturgy starts later and is different.

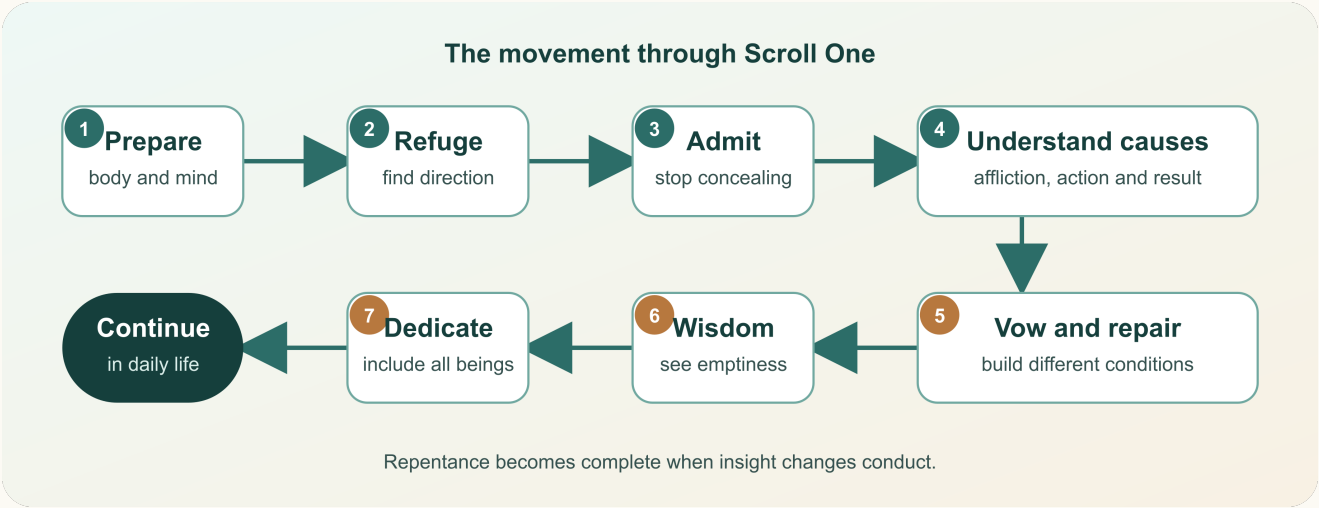
You do not need to stop chanting to resolve every unfamiliar term. Before a section, read **What is happening?** and **What to attend to**. During the liturgy, notice the movement from naming a problem to making a constructive vow. Return to the fuller notes afterwards. Instructions for communal movement and timing still come from the officiant.

> **In simple terms**
> The practice asks: What has caused harm? Can I admit it without hiding? What conditions fed it? What will I do differently? How can the benefit of that change include others?

What the title means

- **Kindness and compassion** name the attitude towards oneself and all beings.
- **Samādhi** is a collected, steady mind that is not swept away by reactions.
- **Water** symbolises cleansing and refers to the spring in the traditional Wuda story.
- **Repentance** means acknowledging harm and reforming future conduct.
- **Liturgy** means a structured communal service of chant, movement, reflection and dedication.

The practice at a glance



The ritual is not simply a long confession. It moves from reverence and attention to honest acknowledgement, analysis of causes, vows, wisdom and dedication.

Movement	Question carried into practice
Prefaces and Wuda narrative	Why can acknowledged harm be changed?
Praise, visualisation and offering	What quality of attention am I bringing?
Refuge and collective confession	What have body, speech and mind been serving?
Three obstructions and seven minds	What caused the harm, what followed, and what attitude supports repair?
Affliction lists and vows	Which recurring pattern needs a wholesome replacement?
Mantra, offering and memorial dedication	How can any benefit extend beyond me?

Guide to Scroll One

1. Imperial Preface for Water Repentance

Source pages 3 to 4

What is happening?

A Ming-period imperial preface explains the title and recommends the practice. It defines samādhi as a mind that does not indulge or chase sensation, then compares repentance with washing a body, garment or vessel.

Why is it here?

The preface gives the reader a moral frame before the chanting begins: actions have effects, the mind is central, and sincere reform can change the conditions that support suffering.

What does it mean?

“Samādhi water” is both story and metaphor. The water cleanses because it is joined with collected awareness, truthfulness and change. The point is not that ordinary water magically deletes the past.

Difficult wording on this page

Source phrase	Plain-English reading	Reading caution
“proper sensation”	A settled awareness that does not chase or indulge sensory experience	This is the edition's unusual gloss for *samādhi*, not a standard definition of a bodily sensation.
“no part of it remains cleansed”	Washing leaves no part **uncleansed**	The next two comparisons say that no dirt or impurity remains. “Cleansed” is therefore an apparent typographical error in the English source.
“square inch of space”	Moral change is located in the intimate work of mind or heart	The English syntax is compressed, so the guide does not claim a more exact technical meaning.
“specs of dust”	Specks of dust, used to suggest an incalculable number	This is another apparent English typo, not a special Buddhist term.

What to attend to

Notice that all three washing comparisons involve action. Water is available, but the body, garment or vessel is actually washed. In the same way, repentance includes recognition and a change of conduct, not a declaration that consequences have vanished.

Beginner notes

- **National Master** was an honorific for a highly respected monastic teacher associated with the imperial court.
- **Karmic enmity** means hostility carried and reinforced through intentional actions, traditionally across lives.
- **Trichiliocosm** is an ancient Buddhist expression for an immensely vast world-system.
- The preface is dated 24 July 1416, much later than the traditional Tang setting of Wuda's story.

2. Preface of the Water Repentance

Source pages 4 to 5

What is happening?

The liturgy tells its traditional origin narrative. Wuda Zhixuan cares for a sick monk when others avoid him. Later, after receiving an imperial throne and becoming proud, Wuda develops a human-faced tumour. The tumour speaks as a former enemy. Honoured Kanaka directs Wuda to wash it with water from a spring, ending the feud.

Why is it here?

The story makes invisible patterns visible. Pride weakens vigilance. Kindness creates a future refuge. Retaliation persists until its causes are understood and released.

What does it mean?

The tumour represents unresolved harm that cannot be escaped by status, learning or denial. Wuda's healing is not only the removal of pain. It is reconciliation with a being presented as his enemy across lives.

The story names the earlier opponents as Yuan Yang and Yao Cuo. It is not necessary to remember the court history to follow the ethical point: one person's past participation in another's death becomes a grievance, and neither prestige nor avoidance resolves it. Care shown to the sick monk later becomes the condition through which help arrives.

Historical note
The Wuda account is the liturgy's traditional explanation. Modern scholarship finds the exact authorship uncertain and notes that versions of the attribution were questioned in medieval China. The guide treats the story as a sacred origin narrative, not verified medical history.

Beginner notes

- **Kāmalā disease** is an old medical term associated with jaundice and severe illness.

- **Honoured Kanaka** is the mysterious awakened helper in the narrative. The text does not give a historically verifiable biography.
- The story assumes rebirth and karmic continuity. It should not be used to blame an ill person for unknown past conduct.

Read illness responsibly

The source uses a frightening illness inside a sacred origin story. It does not provide a method for diagnosing why a particular person is ill. Respond to illness with care, treatment and practical support. Do not turn another person's pain into speculation about guilt.

3. Prostrations and the True Incense Praise

Source page 7

What is happening?

The assembly bows, prostrates three times and praises the “true incense” of ethical discipline and concentration.

Why is it done?

The body enters the practice before the main confession begins. Prostration softens pride, while incense makes intention visible through fragrance rising and spreading.

What does it mean?

The real offering is not smoke alone. Ethical conduct and a steady mind are the fragrance the practitioner is asked to cultivate.

What to attend to

Let the first bows mark a change of pace. The useful question is not whether the movement looks perfect, but whether body and attention arrive together. If you are studying privately, pause long enough to notice defensiveness, hurry or distraction before continuing.

Look for this in a temple
Three prostrations often express complete homage to the Buddha, Dharma and Sangha. Follow the officiant's pace if attending a service.

4. Retelling the Wuda story

Source pages 8 to 10

What is happening?

A formal verse retells the origin story in elevated ritual language. It moves from pride and karmic enmity through the journey to Kanaka and the cleansing water.

Why is it done?

Repetition changes the story from background information into contemplation. Practitioners are invited to recognise their own pride, grudges and hidden patterns.

The elevated wording can be difficult to parse. On source page 8, the sentence beginning “The Honored One practiced kindness” is grammatically incomplete in English. Its surrounding lines still make the ritual movement clear: the awakened response benefits beings, the illness is presented as provisional or dreamlike, and the old grievance is brought to the cleansing water. The guide does not silently invent a missing subject or verb.

Beginner notes

- **Ten unwholesome deeds** are killing, stealing, sexual misconduct; false, divisive, harsh and careless speech; greed, ill will and wrong views.
- **Five degenerations** describe a troubled age marked by decline in lifespan, beings, afflictions, views and the age itself.

- **Nine grades of lotuses** are traditional levels of rebirth in Amitābha's Pure Land.

5. Samantabhadra visualisation

Source pages 10 to 12

What is happening?

The assembly invokes Samantabhadra, then imagines the bodhisattva approaching on a white elephant amid light, flowers, music and countless awakened beings.

Why is it done?

Samantabhadra represents great vows expressed as conduct. The visualisation turns the imagination towards a world shaped by wisdom, beauty and purposeful action.

What does it mean?

The scene should not be read like a newspaper report. It is sacred imagery that trains perception. Light represents wisdom; flowers represent virtue and impermanence; the elephant represents calm strength; its six tusks are commonly linked with the six perfections.

The six perfections are generosity, ethical discipline, patience, diligent effort, meditation and wisdom.

> **Why this matters**
> Repentance is incomplete if it only looks backward. Samantabhadra asks what vow and practice will replace the harmful pattern.

What to attend to

Do not try to construct every visual detail at once. Choose one feature and its quality: steady strength in the elephant, practical commitment in Samantabhadra's vows, or wisdom in the light. Then ask what that quality would change in the next ordinary decision you make.

6. Refuge and universal offering

Source pages 12 to 15

What is happening?

The assembly prostrates to the Buddha, Dharma and Sangha, kneels with incense and flowers, and imagines the offering multiplying throughout all worlds.

Why is it done?

Taking refuge establishes the direction of the practice. The universal offering expands generosity beyond the limits of what is physically present.

What does it mean?

The language in which every offering contains all offerings reflects the Flower Adornment vision of interdependence. A small sincere act can participate in a much wider field of benefit.

This is the first major widening of the scroll. The Wuda story begins with one feud and one healing; the offering now reaches the ten directions. The transition teaches that personal repair is not sealed off from the welfare of others.

Beginner notes

- **Ten directions** means everywhere: the four main directions, four intermediate directions, above and below.
- **Dharma realm** means the whole field of beings and phenomena.
- **Bodhi mind** is the resolve to awaken for the benefit of all beings.
- **Non-arising** means insight that phenomena do not appear from an independent permanent essence.

7. Prayer of entering repentance

Source pages 15 to 18

What is happening?

The assembly formally enters the repentance sanctuary. Practitioners purify body, speech and mind, take refuge, confess and ask the awakened assembly to witness their sincerity.

Why is it done?

Ritual boundaries help the mind stop treating the words as ordinary reading. Kneeling, joined palms, flowers and incense support concentrated honesty.

What does it mean?

“Purifying the three karmas” means bringing bodily conduct, speech and intention into alignment. “Four forms of birth” and “six realms” place the confession within the traditional scope of all sentient life.

The Seven Ancient Buddhas then situate the practice in a lineage of awakening extending beyond one historical age.

What to attend to

The source repeatedly asks that body, speech and mind become pure. Read “pure” here as freed from the harmful direction being confessed. A useful review is concrete: what did the body do, what did speech communicate, and what intention or assumption drove them?

8. Opening confession and Buddha-name litany

Source pages 19 to 23

What is happening?

The assembly admits disbelief, arrogance, neglect of family, intoxicant use, killing, sexual craving and other harmful conduct. It then invokes Buddhas, bodhisattvas and sacred assemblies.

Why is it done?

Naming patterns weakens concealment. Reciting awakened names provides a contrasting field of qualities: wisdom, compassion, strength, vows and liberation.

What does it mean?

The passage uses “we” and covers more wrongdoing than any one reader may have committed. Communal repentance is deliberately comprehensive. A practitioner can acknowledge the pattern without making a false personal confession.

> **Reading responsibly**
> Do not mechanically claim an action you did not commit. Attend to the forms of harm that genuinely apply, the social conditions that allow harm and the commitment to prevent it.

Collective confession works at three levels. You can acknowledge conduct you personally recognise, remain alert to ways you benefit from or fail to interrupt wider harm, and cultivate concern for actions committed by beings generally. None of these requires a false admission. If a line does not describe you, let it train recognition and prevention rather than forcing a private memory to fit it.

What to attend to

When the litany shifts to Buddha and bodhisattva names, notice the change in emotional direction. The assembly has named confusion and harm, then turns towards qualities that make another response possible. Refuge is not a way to avoid repair. It supplies a model, teaching and community for carrying it out.

Beginner notes

- **Field of merit** means a person or community in relation to whom wholesome action bears abundant benefit, like a well-tended field bearing crops.

- **Pratyekabuddha** means one who awakens without teaching a dispensation to the world.
- **Four fruitions and four progressions** are four stages of early Buddhist awakening, each viewed as path and result.
- **Devas and nāgas** are non-human beings in traditional Buddhist cosmology.

9. The three obstructions

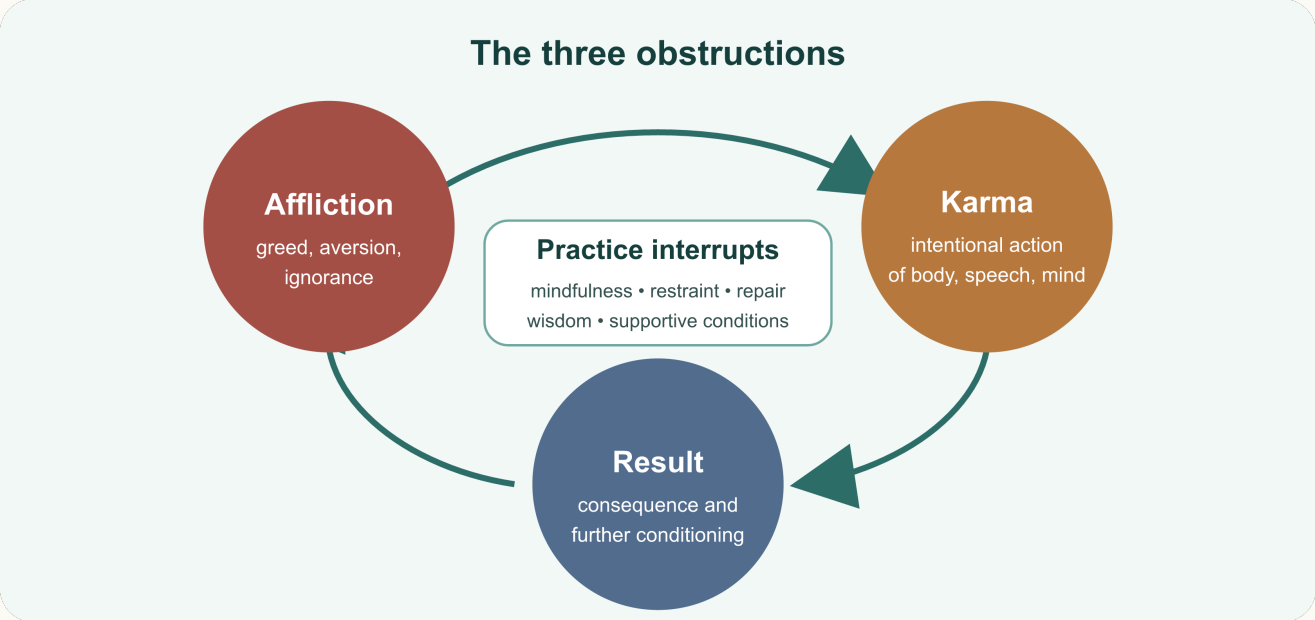
Source pages 23 to 24

What is happening?

The liturgy organises an immense range of wrongdoing into three connected obstructions: afflictions, karma and painful results.

Why is it done?

This turns a catalogue of faults into a diagnosis. If a practitioner sees only the painful result, the inner cause may continue. If they analyse affliction but ignore conduct, insight remains abstract.



What does it mean?

- An **affliction** disturbs clear awareness.
- **Karma** is the intentional action it conditions.
- A **result** is the consequence and further conditioning that follow.

Each can feed the next. The cycle can also be interrupted at every point through mindfulness, restraint, repair, wisdom and supportive conditions.

Everyday sequence	Where practice can interrupt it
Resentment is rehearsed until it feels justified	Name the affliction and check the story being repeated.
A cutting message is drafted and sent	Pause, do not send it, and choose truthful speech that does not humiliate.
Trust is damaged and more resentment follows	Acknowledge impact, apologise without excuses, repair what can be repaired and change the conditions for recurrence.

The three obstructions are a diagnostic sequence, not a claim that every painful event can be traced to one visible fault. Many conditions interact, and the liturgy does not give a practitioner grounds to judge another person's suffering.

10. The seven kinds of mind

Source pages 24 to 31

What is happening?

The assembly cultivates seven attitudes before the detailed confession.

Attitude	Practical meaning
Remorse and shame	Admit that the action fell below one's ethical capacity.
Fear	Take consequences seriously instead of assuming they can be avoided.
Dispassion	See that compulsive pleasure and identity cannot provide lasting security.
Bodhi mind	Make reform part of awakening for all beings.
Equality of friend and foe	Refuse to limit compassion to people one likes.
Gratitude to the Buddha	Repay the teaching by practising and sharing it.
Emptiness of transgression	Take responsibility without fixing anyone as permanently corrupt.

Why is it done?

Repentance can fail through denial, panic, self-hatred, resentment or empty performance. The seven minds create a balance of urgency, compassion and wisdom.

Difficult body imagery

The list of body parts and the nine openings is an ancient contemplation of the body as physical, changing and not fit for idealised attachment. It is not a statement that bodies are morally dirty or that bodily care is wrong.

“Friends and foes as equal”

Equality means equal concern for awakening and freedom from suffering. It does not require trusting an unsafe person, abandoning boundaries or pretending that harmful conduct is acceptable.

“Transgressions are empty”

The text says transgressions arise and cease through conditions. This is not an escape from accountability. It explains why accountability can lead to change.

What to attend to

The seven minds are meant to correct one another. Concern about consequences without compassion can become panic. Emptiness without remorse can become evasion. Equality without boundaries can expose someone to further harm. A balanced reading holds responsibility, the possibility of change and care for everyone affected.

The phrase “permanence, bliss, self-nature, and purity” on source page 28 uses affirmative Mahāyāna language for the realised freedom of a Buddha's nirvāṇa. “Self-nature” here should not be read as the ordinary ego becoming eternal. The surrounding aspiration is towards wisdom, a purified Buddha-field and benefit to beings.

11. Repentance for the obstruction of afflictions

Source pages 32 to 42

What is happening?

The first of the three obstructions becomes the focus. The text begins with greed, anger and ignorance, then expands into a long sequence of numbered lists.

Why is it done?

The sheer range prevents a practitioner from reducing wrongdoing to a few obvious acts. Affliction includes views, habits, doubts, emotional reactions and subtle attachments.

How to read the numbered lists

Treat them as a map of comprehensiveness, not a memory test. A few groups deserve immediate recognition:

- **three poisons**: greed, hatred and ignorance;
- **five coverings**: sense desire, ill will, dullness, restlessness and doubt;
- **six senses**: eye, ear, nose, tongue, body and mind;
- **eight sufferings**: birth, ageing, illness, death, separation from what is loved, meeting what is disliked, not getting what is wanted and distress connected with clinging to the five aggregates;
- **ten afflictions**: a scholastic list of primary disturbed states and wrong views;
- **eighteen realms**: six faculties, six objects and six consciousnesses;
- **108 afflictions**: a comprehensive symbolic count of the many ways a mind becomes troubled.

The glossary explains every named group at the level the source supports. It marks lists whose exact members vary or are not supplied.

Source label	Useful reading during the liturgy	Caution
Eight Defilements, page 37	Mental stains that cloud clear awareness	The source does not enumerate a definitive eight here, so do not force one later list into the passage.
Nine Conditions, page 38	The many supports through which confused consciousness and action arise	It may refer to a technical analysis of sensory consciousness, but the exact intended list is disputed.
Three Vows, page 39	A compact aspiration that wrongdoing be replaced by liberating aims	The three are not named in the English text. Several Buddhist triads share this title.
108 afflictions, pages 38 and 41	A comprehensive count for the many ways the mind becomes troubled	The practice point is breadth, not arithmetic mastery.

What to attend to

Listen for the repeated grammar: “because of” a disturbed condition, harmful actions occur; “through the merits” of repentance, a positive capacity is sought. That pattern is more important for a beginner than remembering every number. Choose one recognised pattern and pair it with one replacement, such as envy with appreciative joy, agitation with steady attention, or stinginess with a planned act of generosity.

From confession to vows

The numerical confession is answered by positive aspirations: wisdom, faith, the six perfections, the factors of awakening and the bodhisattva grounds. This structure matters. The practitioner does not merely remove a fault but develops a capacity that makes recurrence less likely.

12. Rectifying the past and cultivating the future

Source pages 43 to 50

What is happening?

The text explains repentance directly: correct the past, cultivate the future, end harmful patterns and give rise to virtues. It asks the practitioner to make the body dignified, the mind reverent and the practice sincere.

Why is it done?

The warning against hidden conduct targets the belief that an unseen act does not matter. Buddhist ethics focuses on what conduct does to the mind and to beings, not only on whether a human authority discovers it.

King Yama and the wardens of hell

The courtroom scene dramatizes unavoidable accountability. Enemies testify about violence and theft; the offender cannot transfer the consequence to family or wealth.

Traditionally, Yama is a ruler or judge connected with the realms of the dead. He is not an all-powerful creator and Buddhist hell is not eternal. Some readers also understand the scene as a psychological image of actions returning through memory, habit, fear and damaged relationships.

The scene also explains why the scroll places reform before death imagery. Family, status and possessions cannot perform an ethical choice on someone else's behalf. The practical emphasis is to repair while there is time, not to become absorbed in guessing a future sentence.

The four elements, five aggregates and six senses

The text compares the four elements to snakes, the five aggregates to bandits and the six senses to an empty formation. These are warnings against clinging. They do not teach hatred of the body or the senses.

The positive conclusion is the Noble Eightfold Path: right view, intention, speech, action, livelihood, effort, mindfulness and concentration.

“The six senses as a formation of emptiness” is awkward source wording. It does not mean that sight, hearing or touch should be hated or destroyed. The senses, their objects and the resulting consciousness arise through conditions and contain no permanent owner. That makes them workable: contact can be noticed before it hardens into grasping or aversion.

The source prints “Dhama Body” on page 40 in the phrase “Five Parts [of the Dhama Body]”. This is an apparent typo for **Dharma Body**. The five parts are ethical discipline, concentration, wisdom, liberation, and knowledge or vision of liberation.

13. Seven Buddhas mantra and exiting repentance

Source pages 51 to 54

What is happening?

The assembly chants the Seven Buddhas Offence-Extinguishing Mantra, recalls the cleansing spring, announces completion of the first scroll and dedicates the merit.

Why is it done?

The mantra seals the confession in a sacred sound formula. The exit prayer prevents an abrupt return to ordinary activity and directs the result towards a wider field.

What does it mean?

The source provides a Sanskrit-derived recitation rather than a prose translation. Its liturgical function is purification. The following verse gives its practical interpretation: the water of samādhi cleanses old enmity, then compassion for oneself becomes compassion for others.

Dedication includes Dharma protectors, spirits, living relatives, ancestors, friends, enemies and all beings. The aspiration to the Pure Land gives this shared benefit a direction towards awakening.

What to attend to

Let the exit prayer gather the whole scroll into one movement: causes have been examined, responsibility has been taken, and the benefit is released. If you noticed a specific repair during the confession, write it down after the service so that dedication does not replace follow-through.

Why these words are not English

The English heading names the chant, but the line beneath it is a **transliteration**, meaning sacred sounds written in the Latin alphabet. These sounds began in an Indic language, were represented phonetically with Chinese characters, and were then transmitted through centuries of Chinese Buddhist chanting. The Chinese characters in this part often represent sound rather than an ordinary Chinese sentence.

This is why a line such as *ripa ripate* looks like English letters but is not English. Some Sanskrit words remain recognisable, while other syllables cannot be translated securely. In group practice, the officiant and the pinyin line in

the temple text are the pronunciation authority. The cue below is only a calm first reading of the source's Latin-letter line.

Chant guide: Seven Buddhas Offence-Extinguishing Mantra

Where: source PDF page 51, printed page 45.

Source form: *ripa ripate kuha kuhate tranite nigalate*
vimarite mahāgate jāmlamcamte svāhā
Easy cue: *REE-pah REE-pah-tay, KOO-hah KOO-hah-tay, TRAH-nee-tay, NEE-gah-lah-tay; VEE-mah-ree-tay, mah-HAA-gah-tay, JAHM-lahm-CHAHM-tay, SWAA-hah.*

What it means: There is no responsible word-for-word translation of the whole formula. *Mahā* means "great", *gate* is related to going or having gone, and *svāhā* is a traditional ending that seals or completes a mantra. Its Chinese title gives the reliable overall meaning: a mantra of the Seven Buddhas for extinguishing offences.

Why it is chanted: It gathers attention, expresses the intention that harmful karma and its obstructions be purified, and seals the confession before the exit prayer. It should be understood as a purification formula, not as a hidden English sentence.

14. Noon Offering Before the Buddhas

Source pages 55 to 58

What is happening?

The assembly invokes the Triple Gem, major Buddhas and bodhisattvas, then chants formulas for transforming food, sweet dew and universal offering.

Why is it done?

Food, one of life's basic supports, becomes a practice of gratitude and impartial generosity. The offering is imagined as reaching Buddhas, sages and all beings in the six realms.

What does it mean?

"Transformation" and "sweet dew" express abundance and relief. The physical portion may be limited, but the vow to nourish and include beings is not.

The transition from confession to food offering is deliberate. Ethical practice is tested in how life's supports are received and shared. Notice gratitude for the people, labour and living systems that made the meal possible, then widen the wish from "may I be fed" to "may beings have what supports life and practice".

Chant guide: Transformation of Food Dhāraṇī

Where: source PDF page 57, printed page 51. It is repeated on source pages 61-62 in the memorial rite.

Source form: *Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatāvalokite; oṃ sambhara sambhara hūṃ*
Easy cue: *NAH-mah SAR-vah tah-THAA-gah-TAA-vah-loh-kee-tay; ohm SUM-bha-rah SUM-bha-rah hoom.*

Plain meaning: "Homage to all the Tathāgatas who behold", followed by a formula calling the offering to be gathered, supplied or made abundant. *Hūṃ* is a forceful closing syllable and is gently nasalised.

Why it is chanted: A limited physical portion is imaginatively transformed into an offering sufficient for innumerable beings. The point is boundless generosity, not a claim that the food's chemistry visibly changes.

Chant guide: Sweet Dew Dhāraṇī

Where: source PDF page 57, printed page 51. It is repeated on source page 62.

Source form: *Namaḥ surūpāya tathāgatāya tadyathā; oṃ suru suru pra suru pra suru svāhā*
Easy cue: *NAH-mah soo-ROO-paa-yah tah-THAA-gah-taa-yah tud-yuh-THAA; ohm SOO-roo SOO-roo prah SOO-roo prah SOO-roo SWAA-hah.*

Plain meaning: The opening honours the Beautiful-Form Tathāgata and introduces the formula with “thus”. The repeated *suru* sounds do not have a secure separate English meaning here. “Sweet dew” translates *amṛta*, the deathless nectar used as an image of Dharma relief and liberation.

Why it is chanted: It expresses the wish that the offering become cooling, nourishing relief for hungry or distressed beings and lead beyond suffering.

Chant guide: Universal Offering Dhāraṇī

Where: source PDF page 58, printed page 52. It is repeated on source page 62.

> **Source form:** *Oṃ gagana sambhava vajra hoḥ*
> **Easy cue:** *ohm GAH-gah-nah SUM-bha-vah VAJ-rah hoh.*

Plain meaning: The recoverable words suggest “born or arisen from space” and *vajra*, the diamond or thunderbolt symbol of indestructible awakened power. *Hoḥ* is a concluding ritual syllable. The formula is better understood by its function than forced into a complete English sentence.

Why it is chanted: It expands the offering beyond one altar or one group, imagining it as vast as space and available throughout the Dharma realm.

Chant cue within the Celestial Kitchen Praise

Where: source PDF page 58, printed page 52.

> **Source form:** *Oṃ suru-sarva tathāgata tadyathā suru svāhā*
> **Easy cue:** *ohm SOO-roo SAR-vah tah-THAA-gah-tah tud-yuh-THAA SOO-roo SWAA-hah.*

Plain meaning and purpose: *Sarva tathāgata* means “all Tathāgatas” and *tadyathā* means “thus”. The *suru* sounds are retained rather than guessed at. Within the praise, the line consecrates the food offering and directs it towards all Buddhas and beings.

Beginner notes

- **Vulture Peak** is the site near ancient Rājagṛha associated with important Mahāyāna teachings, especially the *Lotus Sūtra*.
- **Medicine Master Buddha** represents healing and conditions supportive of practice.
- **Sanghārāma Bodhisattvas** are guardians of Buddhist monasteries and practice places.
- **Dhyāna bliss** is the joy and ease associated with meditative collectedness.

15. Memorial Altar Dedication

Source pages 59 to 64

What is happening?

The service invokes Amitābha, chants the *Heart Sūtra*, recites the Rebirth in the Pure Land Dhāraṇī, repeats offering formulas and makes a final dedication.

Why is it done?

The memorial rite joins compassion for the deceased with wisdom about emptiness. Grief is not denied. It is held within a practice that refuses to cling to a fixed self while aspiring towards favourable conditions for awakening.

What does the *Heart Sūtra* mean here?

Avalokiteśvara sees that the five aggregates are empty of independent essence and crosses beyond suffering. The sūtra then removes every possible object of clinging, even Buddhist teachings and attainment. Its mantra points beyond ordinary conceptual grasping.

This does not say that people or grief are unreal. It says they arise through conditions and cannot be possessed as permanent, separate things.

What to attend to

The memorial sequence holds grief and wisdom together. Bring the deceased to mind without trying to manufacture a particular feeling. The practice offers remembrance, recitation and a direction towards awakening; it does not ask the mourner to deny loss or claim certainty about a person's present state.

Chant guide: Heart Sūtra mantra

Where: source PDF page 61, printed page 55.

> **Source form:** *gate gate pāragate pārasaṃgate bodhi svāhā*
> **Easy cue:** *GAH-tay GAH-tay PAA-rah-gah-tay PAA-rah-sung-gah-tay BOH-dhee SWAA-hah.*

Plain meaning: A common interpretive rendering is “gone, gone, gone beyond, gone completely beyond, awakening, svāhā”. It is not a command to travel physically. It points to wisdom crossing beyond clinging and fixed concepts.

Why it is chanted: The mantra condenses the Heart Sūtra's movement beyond fear and attachment into a memorable closing formula.

Chant guide: Rebirth in the Pure Land Dhāraṇī

Where: source PDF page 61, printed page 55.

> **Source form:** *Namo'mitābhāya tathāgatāya tadyathā; [oṃ] amṛtod bhave amṛta-siddhaṃ bhave; amṛta-vikrānte amṛta-vikrānta; gāmini gagana kīrta kāre svāhā*
> **Easy cue:** *NAH-moh ah-mee-TAA-bhaa-yah tah-THAA-gah-taa-yah tud-yuh-THAA; ohm uh-MRIH-tohd BHAH-vay, uh-MRIH-tah SID-dhum BHAH-vay; uh-MRIH-tah vee-KRAAN-tay, uh-MRIH-tah vee-KRAAN-tah; GAA-mee-nee GAH-gah-nah KEER-tah KAA-ray SWAA-hah.*

Plain meaning: The opening is clear: “Homage to Amitābha Tathāgata; thus”. *Amṛta* means “deathless” and also “nectar”, while *siddhaṃ* concerns accomplishment. Later words suggest powerful advance, going and space, but the transmitted grammar is not secure enough for a confident full translation.

Why it is chanted: The overall purpose is purification, recollection of Amitābha and aspiration for rebirth in Sukhāvatī, where practice can continue towards awakening without ordinary regression.

Why Amitābha?

Amitābha's vows and Pure Land provide a focus for remembrance, trust and aspiration. “Guide and Receiver of the West” expresses the hope that beings will be welcomed into conditions where practice continues without regression.

When you hear “Nam Mô A Di Đà Phật”

This Vietnamese Buddha-name recitation means **“Homage to Amitābha Buddha”** or **“I take refuge in Amitābha Buddha”**. A rough Southern Vietnamese cue is *nahm moh ah yee dah fuht*. The last word, *Phật*, ends with a short, unreleased “t”. Follow the temple's tones and rhythm when chanting with the community.

Reciting the name is not simply praying to the “next layer”. It recollects Amitābha and voices the wish to be reborn after this life in **Sukhāvatī**, his Western Pure Land or Buddha-field. The liturgy pictures the nine grades of lotus blossoms as one's parents: this is transformational or lotus birth rather than ordinary birth from a womb.

> **The lotus with your name:** Some later Pure Land teaching materials say that sincere faith, vows, name-recitation and practice nourish a lotus in Sukhāvatī associated with the practitioner, sometimes pictured as bearing the practitioner's name. This is a devotional visualisation, not a sentence found in the Water Repentance or the shorter *Amitābha Sūtra*. Its practical message is that each recitation strengthens one's direction towards the Pure Land, and the opening lotus represents awakening and seeing Amitābha.

The closing synthesis

The final wish names Chan, Pure Land, precepts and the patience of equality. It is a compact picture of integrated East Asian Mahāyāna practice:

- Chan steadies and examines the mind;

- Pure Land directs recollection and aspiration;
- precepts guide conduct;
- equality extends patience and compassion without discrimination.

A practical way to carry the text into daily life

After reading a section, use four short questions:

1. **What happened?** Name the action without disguise.
2. **What fed it?** Notice craving, aversion, ignorance and surrounding conditions.
3. **What can be repaired?** Apologise, restore, protect or seek help where appropriate.
4. **What will replace it?** Make a specific vow and build conditions that support it.

Then dedicate any benefit beyond yourself. This is the ethical movement at the heart of Scroll One.

For a recurring pattern, make the replacement observable. “Be kinder” is hard to test. “Wait ten minutes before replying when angry”, “repay the amount on Friday”, or “ask before sharing someone else's story” creates a condition that can actually support reform.

References

Sources and editorial limits

The original reference set was checked on 24 August 2026. Sources added for the expanded figure profiles and reading aids were checked on 27 September 2026. This does not claim that every earlier external link was rechecked on the later date. The guide paraphrases its copyrighted source and uses short labels only where necessary for explanation.

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- Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple. *Scroll Two*. Electronic edition 3.0, 2022. Main source for the Scroll Two guide and page map.
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The PDFs credit Andrew Nguy and Raymond Kong as translators, editors and graphic designers. They state that reproduction requires the publisher's permission except for fair use. The original PDFs are therefore not included in this repository.

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Figure relationships and recognition

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Artwork records

Each image caption in FIGURES.md gives its direct museum or Wikimedia source and licence. Key collection records include:

- The Metropolitan Museum of Art: Avalokiteśvara, Samantabhadra, Mahāsthāmaprāpta and Kṣitigarbha.
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- Sanskrit names and terms are normalised only where the identification is secure. The source spelling remains the reference for chanting.
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- Lotus birth is distinguished from the later devotional image of a name-bearing lotus. The former is widely attested in Pure Land sources; the latter is presented as a teaching image, not as a sentence from the source liturgy.
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- The traditional Wuda narrative is explained respectfully and distinguished from historical verification.

May the benefit of this work support understanding, compassionate reform and the awakening of all beings.